SAAS CUSTOMER CHURN ANALYSIS

What's driving customer loss and what to do about it.

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Find the full project on Github

THE SITUATION

- A SaaS company asked: Who is churning, When, and Why?
- Analyzed 1,000 customer records from Jan 2024 to Jun 2025.
- Three plan types investigated: Basic, Enterprise, and Pro.
- Examined acquisition cost, plan type, and tenure as potential churn predictors.

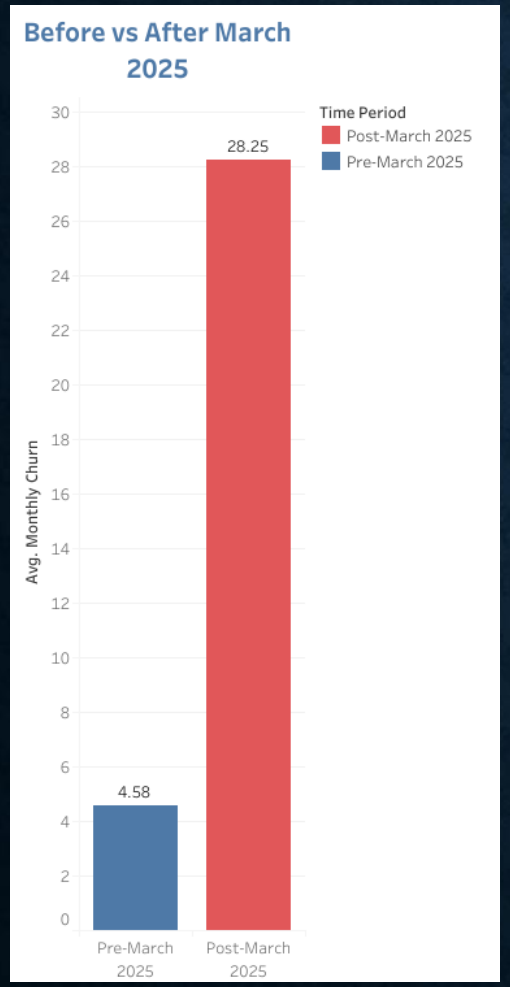
WHAT WE FOUND

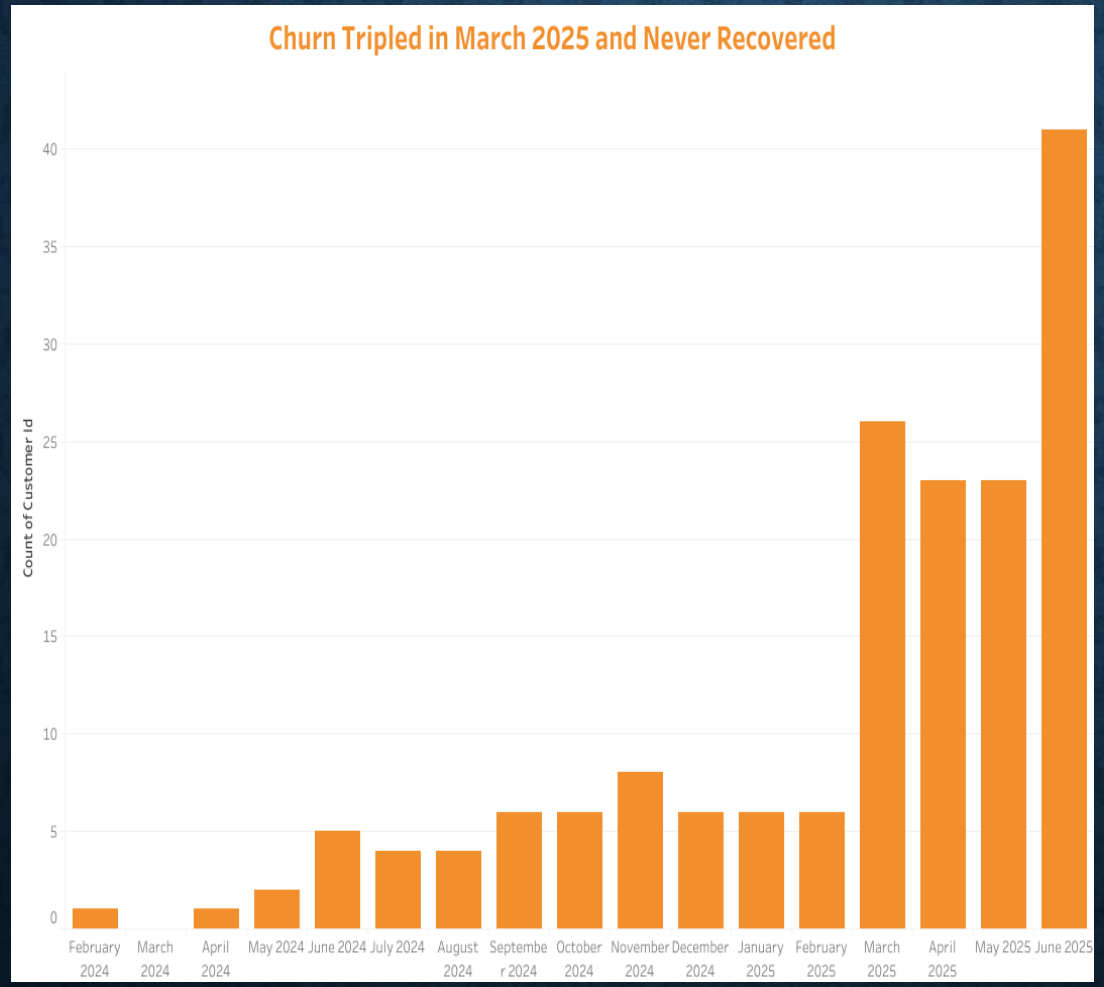
Something Changed in March 2025 and the data points directly to it.

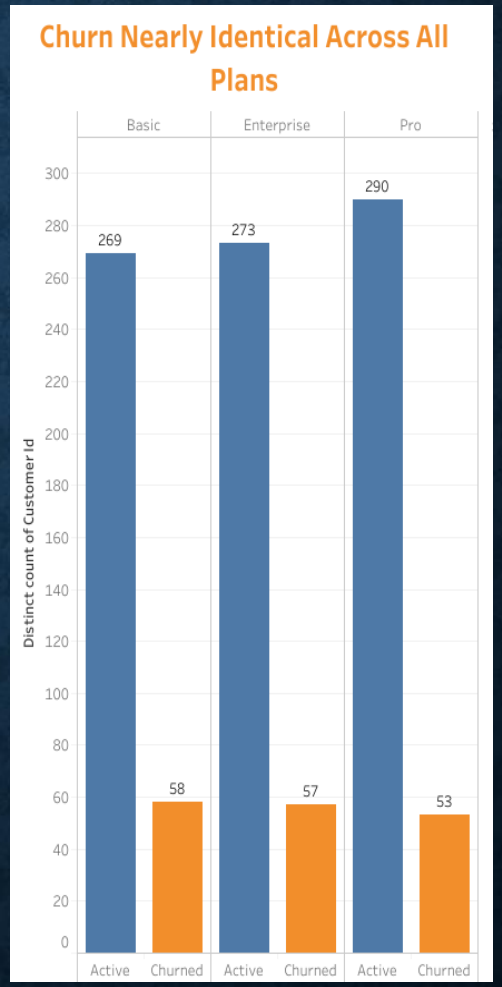
- Churn was stable for over a year, then spiked abruptly.
- Churn *tripled* in March 2025 and never recovered, spiking again in June 2025.
- Plan type does not predict churn. Rates nearly identical: Basic 17.7%, Enterprise 17.3%, Pro 15.4%.
- Acquisition Cost does not predict churn. Less than a $0.50 difference between active and churned customers.

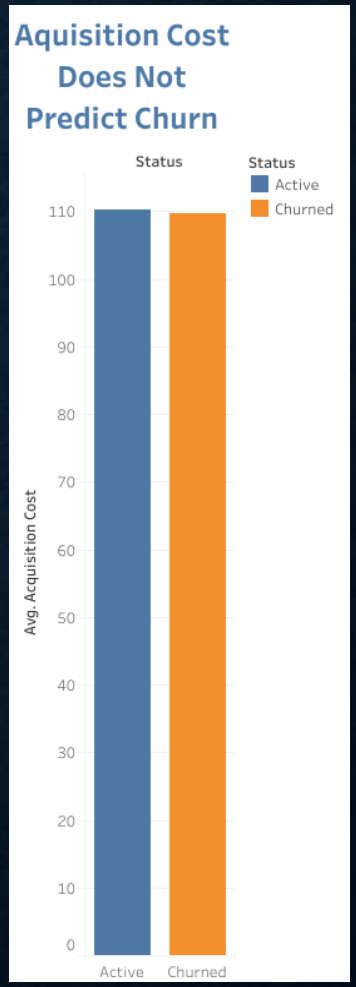
THE EVIDENCE

View On Tableau









WHAT THIS MEANS

- Recurring revenue and Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) is at *risk*.
- The data points to a specific event or change around March 2025 as the primary driver of churn.
- Because churn is not tied to plan type or acquisition cost, the root cause is more likely tied to product, experience, or operational changes.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Investigate March - June 2025
   - Cross reference marketing campaigns, support tickets, and development changelog.
2. Extend The Dataset To Present Day
   - Confirm if churn is still elevated or has been resolved.
3. Month 4 Proactive Outreach
   - Customer Success check-in before customers reach the churn window.
4. One Question Exit Survey
   - Direct evidence that no internal data analysis can't replace.

CLOSING

- This analysis identifies where the problem is. The next step is confirming what caused it.
- Churn is not tied to plan type or acquisition cost implying the opportunity is identifying what changed and correcting it before further revenue and CLV is lost.
- Investigating March is urgent and should be started immediately.

APPENDIX - METHODOLOGY

All SQL queries available on Github

Data Source:

- SaaS Business Metrics Customers, Plans, and Revenue
- Kaggle
- 1,000 records

Tools:

- SQL (SQLiteOnline)
- Excel
- Tableau Public
- PowerPoint

Alterations:

- Columns removed: Amount (duplicate of monthly_fee), Subscription sheet (no new information).
- Joined files: Customers and Revenue using XLOOKUP on customer_id.
- Calculated active customer tenure as of 06/30/2025 to avoid data staleness.